

PACKAGE INSERT

PROZINE SYRUP 5MG/5ML

Each 5ml contains:
Promethazine HCl 5mg

Product Description: A clear, light brown syrup with orange flavour.

Pharmacodynamics:

Promethazine hydrochloride, a phenothiazine derivative, possesses anti-histamine, sedative, anti-motion sickness, anti-emetic and anti-cholinergic effects. The duration of action is generally from four to six hours. The major side reaction of this drug is sedation. As an anti-histamine it acts by competitive antagonism, but does not block the release of histamine. It antagonises in varying degree most but not all of the pharmacological effects of histamine.

Pharmacokinetics:

It is readily absorbed from the gastro-intestinal tract. Following oral administration the effects start within 15 to 20 minutes and are fully developed within one hour. The highest concentration occurs in the lungs, progressively lower concentration in the spleen, kidney, brain, muscle and skin. Small amounts of the drug is excreted unchanged, most appears as degradation products that are almost completely excreted within 24 hours. The main site of metabolic transformation is the liver but the lung and kidneys can also metabolise the compound.

Indication:

In addition to its antihistaminic action, which is of marked potency and prolonged duration, it also provides antiemetic as well as sedative actions.

Promethazine HCl is useful in the management of the following conditions:

- a) Dermographism
- b) Vasomotor rhinitis
- c) Perennial and seasonal allergic rhinitis
- d) Antiemetic therapy in postoperative patients
- e) Mild, uncomplicated allergic skin manifestation of urticaria and angioedema
- f) Prevention and control of nausea and vomiting associated with certain types of anaesthesia and surgery
- g) Sedation in both children and adults as well as relief of apprehension and production of light sleep from which the patient can be easily aroused
- h) Preoperative, post-operative or obstetric sedation
- i) Amelioration of allergic reactions to blood or plasma
- j) Active and prophylactic treatment of motion sickness
- k) Allergic conjunctivitis due to inhalant allergens and foods

Recommended Dosage:

Allergy

The average oral dose is 25mg, taken before retiring; however 12.5mg may be taken before meals and on retiring, if necessary. For children more than 2 years, a single 25mg dose at bedtime or 5mg to 15mg taken three times daily will usually suffice.

After initiation of treatment in children (more than 2 years) or adults, dosage should be adjusted to the smallest amount adequate to relieve symptoms.

Motion sickness

The average adult dose is 25mg taken twice daily. The initial dose should be taken one-half to one hour before anticipated travel and be repeated eight to twelve hours later, if necessary. On succeeding days of travel, it is recommended that 25mg be given on arising and again before the evening meal.

For children (more than 2 years), 12.5mg to 25mg twice daily may be administered.

For nausea and vomiting in children the dose should be adjusted to the age and weight of the patient and the severity of the condition being treated.

For prophylaxis of nausea and vomiting, as during surgery and the post-operative period, the average dose is 25mg repeated at four to six hour intervals as necessary.

Sedation

Administration of 12.5mg to 25mg induces a quiet sleep from which the patient can be easily aroused. Adults usually require 25mg for night time, pre-surgical or obstetrical sedation.

Route of Administration: Oral

Contraindications:

Promethazine is contraindicated in comatose states, in patients who have received large amounts of central nervous system depressants (e.g. alcohol, barbiturates, narcotics, etc.) and in patients who have demonstrated an idiosyncrasy or hypersensitivity to promethazine. Contraindicated for use in treatment of lower respiratory tract symptoms including asthma.

Warnings and Precautions:

Promethazine should be used with caution in patients with narrow-angle glaucoma, prostatic hypertrophy, stenosing peptic ulcer, pyloroduodenal obstruction and bladder-neck obstruction. It should be used with caution in patients with bone marrow depression. Ambulatory patients should be cautioned against driving automobiles or operating dangerous machinery until it is known that they do not become drowsy or dizzy from promethazine hydrochloride therapy.

Children: Should not be used for children under 2 years of age as safety is not established.

Excessively large dosages of promethazine in children may cause hallucinations, convulsions, and sudden death. This product contains promethazine hydrochloride. When used for treatment of cough and cold, it should not be used in paediatric patients less than 2 years of age because of the potential for fatal respiratory depression. To be used with caution and doctor's / pharmacist's advice in children 2 to 6 years of age. Anti-emetics may mask the symptoms of an unrecognised disease and thereby interfere with diagnosis.

Interactions with Other Medicaments:

The sedative action of promethazine hydrochloride is additive to the sedative effects of CNS depressants; therefore agents such as alcohol, barbiturates and narcotic analgesics should either be eliminated or given in reduced dosage in the presence of promethazine hydrochloride. When given concomitantly with promethazine hydrochloride the dose of barbiturates should be reduced by at least one-half and the dose of analgesic depressants, such as morphine or meperidine, should be reduced by one quarter to one half.

Pregnancy and Lactation:

The safe use of promethazine has not been established with respect to the possible adverse effects upon fetal development. Therefore the need for the use of this drug during pregnancy should be weighed against the possible but unknown hazards to the developing fetus. It is not known whether promethazine is excreted in human milk. Caution should be exercised when promethazine is administered to a nursing mother.

Side Effects:

Autonomic reactions such as dryness of the mouth, blurring of vision, and rarely dizziness may occasionally arise. Very rare cases have been reported where patients receiving promethazine have developed leukopenia. In one instance agranulocytosis has been reported. In nearly every instance reported, other toxic agents known to have caused these conditions have been associated with the administration of promethazine.

Cardiovascular effects from promethazine have been rare. Minor increases in blood pressure and occasional mild hypotension have been reported. Photosensitivity, although extremely rare has been reported. Occurrence of photosensitivity may be a contraindication to further treatment with promethazine or related drugs.

Suicidal doses have resulted in deep sedation, coma, rarely convulsions and cardiorespiratory symptoms compatible with the depth of sedation present.

A paradoxical reaction has been reported in children receiving single doses of 75mg to 125mg orally, characterised by hyperexcitability and nightmares.

Symptoms and Treatment of Overdose:

Signs and symptoms of overdose range from mild depression of the CNS and cardiovascular system to profound hypotension, respiratory depression and unconsciousness. Stimulation may be evident, especially in children and geriatric patients. Atropine-like signs and symptoms such as dry mouth, fixed dilated pupils, flushing etc. as well as gastrointestinal symptoms may occur.

Treatment: Treatment of overdose is essentially symptomatic and supportive.

Early gastric lavage may be beneficial. Severe hypotension usually responds to the administration of levaterenol or phenylephrine. Extrapyramidal reactions may be treated with anticholinergics, anti-parkinson agents, diphenhydramine or barbiturates. Additional measures include oxygen and intravenous fluids.

Storage Conditions: Store at or below 30°C. Protect from light.

Pack Size: 60ml, 100ml and 120ml.

Pack Size (export only): 1 litre and 3.8 litres.

Shelf-Life: 2 years.

FURTHER INFORMATION CONCERNING THIS DRUG CAN BE OBTAINED FROM YOUR FAMILY PHYSICIAN / LOCAL GENERAL PRACTITIONER / PHARMACIST.

Manufacturer & Product Registration Holder:
SUNWARD PHARMACEUTICAL SDN. BHD.

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